Fight for Manhood — Week 1

Isaiah 3:12

> *"O My people! Their oppressors are children, and women rule over them..."*

— Isaiah 3:12 NASB

Week 1

Scripture speaks

The Bible speaks directly to:

- strength
- responsibility
- leadership
- legacy

Scripture not only defines manhood.
It shows what happens when it is lost.

Week 1

The problem now

Something is off.

Many men feel:

uncertain	aimless	disconnected	angry	restless	unformed

> *Most men feel it.*
> *Few men know how to explain it.*

"He will restore the hearts of the fathers to their children and the hearts of the children to their fathers, so that I will not come and smite the land with a curse."

— Malachi 4:6 NASB

Would you like to see what that looks like?

You are living in it.

Here is how it happened.

Week 1

There is a pattern

How did so many men become unformed?

This did not happen overnight.

There is a pattern.

The Original Design

Before the fracture

Before the fracture, fathers and sons lived and worked side by side.

Manhood was formed up close.

Boys learned manhood through:

- presence
- observation
- correction
- affirmation
- responsibility

Era 1

1880s — Industrial Revolution

- work moved out of the home
- fathers left daily formation for outside provision
- provider began replacing presence

Era 1

How this affected men

Men were still working hard,
but boys were no longer seeing manhood up close every day.

> *Provision remained.*
> *Presence decreased.*
>
> *Boys lost daily masculine formation.*

Era 2

1900s — World Wars

- millions of men were pulled from their homes
- some never returned
- others came back scarred and silent
- boys lost steady masculine presence

Era 2

How this affected men

Many boys grew up without fathers.
Others had fathers who came home carrying silence, trauma, and distance.

> *Strength was present,*
> *but often no longer emotionally available.*

1960s — Authority Shift

- prayer removed from public schools
- distrust of old authority structures increased
- the home, the culture, and public life began shifting
- masculine leadership weakened further

Era 3

How this affected men

As authority weakened,
boys had fewer stable anchors.

> *Masculinity was no longer being reinforced clearly by fathers, institutions, or culture.*
>
> *Formation became less certain.*

Era 4

1970s — Sexual Revolution

- no-fault divorce laws spread
- abortion was legalized
- homosexuality was removed from the APA
- sexual norms loosened dramatically
- desire was increasingly detached from covenant, responsibility, and legacy

How this affected men

Desire became less connected to covenant and more connected to self.

Men were trained to seek pleasure without responsibility, intimacy without commitment, and identity without formation.

1990s–2000s — Consumerism & Medicated Pain

- identity shifted from who you are to what you consume
- pain was increasingly medicated instead of healed
- pornography became more available and normalized
- men learned distraction, numbing, and escape

Era 5

How this affected men

Instead of healing pain,
many men learned to manage it.

> *Work, screens, pills, pornography, and distraction*
> *helped men function*
> *while remaining inwardly unwell.*

Era 6

2010s–2020s — Identity Confusion

- identity became increasingly self-defined
- political correctness intensified confusion
- political hatred intensified division
- boys and men were told masculinity was suspect
- the culture became more unstable and fragmented

Era 6

How this affected men

Many men were left unsure
whether masculinity was something to build
or something to apologize for.

> *Identity became unstable,*
> *contested,*
> *and self-assembled from fragments.*

Timeline Summary

The pattern

Provider replaced presence.

Boys stopped being formed by present men.

We are still living in the fallout.

Week 1

The results of the lack of masculinity in our society

- men become directionless and troubled
- men become confused
- women compensate
- families strain
- society reflects it

> *These are not isolated problems.*
> *They are connected consequences.*

Result 1

Men become directionless and troubled.

- uncertain what is worth fighting for
- hesitant in relationships
- surrounded by people, yet deeply alone
- able to meet demands, but unclear what they believe

Result 2

Men become confused.

Identity gets assembled from fragments:

- culture
- media
- peers
- trial and error

> *"No one said,*
> *'You are ready.'"*

Result 3

Women compensate.

When men are absent,
someone carries the weight.

> *This is not condemning women.*
> *It is describing what happens*
> *when male presence collapses.*

Result 4

Families strain.

- women carry weight meant to be shared
- fathers withdraw, become passive, or become controlling
- children absorb instability
- what is not healed transfers quietly

Result 5

Society reflects it.

- identity shifts from who you are to what you have
- comparison replaces contribution
- envy replaces purpose
- even the church feels the effect

> *Men attend.*
>
> *But remain spiritually passive.*

THE HOUSEPLANT

Want to understand what happened to many boys?

Think of a houseplant.

A plant can be damaged in different ways.
So can a boy.

Crushed / Neglected

Crushed

- Abuse & Violence
- Abandonment
- Humiliation & Chaos

Neglected

- No water
- No sunlight
- No cultivation

Not destroyed all at once. They withered slowly.

Never formed / Overcontrolled

Many boys were simply never formed.
No one steadily helped them become: strong, clear, responsible, grounded, secure.

Some were overcontrolled.
They received pressure without preparation, correction without equipping, demands without formation.

> *They were trimmed, but never strengthened.*

THE ADULT RESULT

- Troubled
- Uncertain
- Hesitant
- Disconnected
- Reactive
- Dominated by Appetite
- Alone

This is what damaged or unformed boys often look like as men.

HOW MEN TRY TO FEEL LIKE REAL MEN

Men try to ***feel*** like real men instead of ***becoming*** real men.

They chase **intensity** instead of **integrity**:

- Alcohol
- Pornography
- Work
- Adrenaline
- Screens & Social
- Religion

Intensity can feel **powerful**.
Integrity takes **formation**.

False Refuges: Managed, Not Healed

Relief is not restoration. A false refuge gives a temporary feeling of strength without requiring real healing.

Pain is managed, not healed. Men stay endlessly occupied so they do not have to be honest about their condition.

Games / Media

Offer progress & affirmation

Work / Screens

Offer structure & distraction

NONE OF THESE CAN GIVE IDENTITY.

A Biblical Warning

Isaiah 3

"Before we explain it,

let’s read it."

For behold, the Lord GOD of hosts
is taking away from Jerusalem and from
Judah
support and supply,
all support of bread,
and all support of water;
the mighty man and the warrior,
the judge and the prophet,
the diviner and the elder,

the captain of fifty
and the man of rank,
the counselor and the skillful magician
and the expert enchanter.

And I will make mere lads their princes,
and capricious children will rule over them,

And the people will be oppressed,
each one by another, and each one by his neighbor;
the youth will storm against the elder
and the inferior against the honorable.

— ISAIAH 3:4–5 NASB

“O My people! Their oppressors are children,
and women rule over them.
O My people! Those who guide you lead you astray
And confuse the direction of your paths.”

— Isaiah 3:12 NASB —

Identity Issue

This is not merely a political issue.

It is an identity issue.

The deeper problem is not just what society is doing.

It is what men have not become.

If men are not formed, society will not be stable.

This is your story too

This is not just society. This is your story.

You were shaped by:

- Presence or Absence
- Clarity or Confusion
- Strength or Passivity
- Affirmation or Silence
- Formation or Neglect

The question is not only, "What happened to society?"

The question is, **"What shaped me?"**

SEE IT. NAME IT. REFUSE IT.

Your first step is not to fix everything.

See it

See the pattern.

Name it

Name what is true.

Refuse it

Refuse one false refuge this week.

The real hope

> **"Clarity is not small."**
>
> When a man can finally see what shaped him,
> he has already begun to come out of the fog.

You might be thinking...

- → Will this deal with relationships, marriage, and family? **Yep.**
- → Will it explain societal shifts and passive church culture? **Yep.**
- → Will it help with anger, procrastination, and action? **Yep.**
- → Will it show me the solid characteristics of a real man? **Yep.**

I could go on...

Week 2 begins here

“You cannot heal what
you do not understand.”

Week 2 begins showing you what shaped you
and where the fight now lives in you.

Clarity is the first step toward restoration.